technology infrastructure. The applications running on it will help us achieve information superiority. These will also provide us capabilities such as situational awareness, collaborative planning and sensor-to-shooter linkages as envisaged in our doctrine. Thus these network-centric systems and information warfare capabilities would act as war-winning force multipliers and give us the desired edge over the adversary.

India is renowned for its prowess in the information technology (IT) field but it was realized that we had not been able to exploit this IT dominance in the military domain. Therefore, I took the initiative to set up the Army Information and Technology Advisory Council. This council comprised prominent IT industry leaders, management experts, academicians and senior army officers. I was very happy to see the response of major IT companies like Microsoft, Wipro, NIIT, Hewlett Packard and Rolta, who nominated senior executives to be part of this council. This group was mandated to render advice in the formulation of an IT perspective plan for the Indian Army. The council holds a meeting twice a year to monitor the progress of various projects to make us into a network-enabled army. The first meeting of this council was held in April 2006 and was presided over by me.

To achieve the objective of network-centricity and IT dominance, projects like the battlefield surveillance system, the command information decision support system, and the artillery command and control and communications system received renewed focus. I am more than satisfied to see these projects being gradually deployed on ground. The information and communication technology projects that saw the light of day during my tenure are listed in Appendix 6.

As far as the logistics are concerned, two of my KRAs as the chief were modernization as well as improvement of the teeth-to-tail ratio. Therefore, my focus was on upgradation of the existing logistics infrastructure, pruning the strength of logistic units and offloading as many areas of administrative support of the army as possible to the public sector undertakings and trade. Holding of